



Announcement

Faculty of Graduate Studies, Mahidol University

Subject: Requirements and Guidelines for Electronic File Preparation for Graduate Studies, Mahidol University, B.E. 2569 (2026)

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To ensure that the preparation and compilation of theses, thematic paper, and independent studies by graduate student of Mahidol University are conducted in an orderly, efficient, and standardized manner;

By virtue of the authority granted under No. 108 and 109 of Section 11 Procedures for Thesis or Independent Study, Part 2 Thesis or Independent Study Defense Examination, and No. 115 and 116 of Section 12 Academic Graduation of the Mahidol University Regulation on Graduate Studies, B.E. 2567 (2024), and pursuant to the resolution of the Faculty of Graduate Studies Committee at Meeting No. 1/2569 on January 21, B.E. 2569 (2026), the Faculty of Graduate Studies hereby issues the following guidelines for Electronic File preparation:

No. 1 In this announcement,

"Student" refers to graduate students of Mahidol University, including both Master's and Doctoral degree student.

"Advisor" refers to the thesis, thematic paper, or independent study advisor responsible for supervising the student in acquiring knowledge, skills, and research competency in order to complete a thesis, thematic paper, or independent study at the graduate level.

"Program Chair" refers to the Chair of the Program Administrative Committee for the graduate program to which the student affiliated.

"Electronic File" refers to the electronic file of the completed thesis, thematic paper, or independent study approved by the advisor and Program Chair, prepared according to the formats and procedures specified in this announcement as part of the graduation requirements.

"System" refers to the e-Thesis submission system.

No. 2 The period and conditions for submitting the Electronic File are hereby prescribed in accordance with the Mahidol University Regulation on Graduate Studies. Student is required to submit the complete Electronic File in compliance with the following conditions and within the specified timeframe as detailed below:

2.1 The student shall submit the complete Electronic File within 21 days from the date the examination result is recorded as “Pass”.

2.2 In case the student fails to submit the Electronic File within the period specified in No. 2.1, the student must pay a late-submission fine at the rate prescribed by the Faculty of Graduate Studies. In all cases, the delay shall not exceed 90 days from the submission date specified in No. 2.1.

2.3 In case the submission exceeds the period specified in No. 2.2, the student shall submit a written request for extension stating reasons and necessity for approval from the Dean of the Faculty of Graduate Studies, with prior approval by the advisor and the program chair. The extension period requested shall not exceed 180 days.

2.4 In case the student fails to complete the submission of the Electronic File within the period specified under No. 2.3, the thesis examination result shall be changed to “Fail,” and the Faculty of Graduate Studies shall propose to the President that the student be dismissed from student status.

No. 3 To specify the types and formats of Electronic File align with international standards and to reduce processing time in cases where student has published or has had their work accepted for publication, the Faculty of Graduate Studies hereby establishes the following criteria:

3.1 The classification of Electronic File types according to the study plan shall be categorized Electronic File as following:

- (1) Thesis,
- (2) Thematic Paper,
- (3) Independent Study.

3.2 The determination of the Electronic File, the major advisor shall determine the format of the Electronic File at the time of submitting the request for the appointment of the thesis, thematic paper, or independent study examination committee. The formats are classified into 2 types as follows:

(1) Traditional Format refers to a format of the Electronic File following the structure and content organization prescribed by the Faculty of Graduate Studies. Conditions are defined by study plan as follows:

a. Thesis: The student must follow the full structure and content organization set by the Faculty of Graduate Studies.

b. Thematic Paper: The student may follow the Traditional Format with clearly defined chapters, as determined by the Faculty of Graduate Studies, or in a format similar to that of an independent study, depending on the nature and appropriateness of the research content.

c. Independent Study: The student shall follow the basic structure of the Traditional Format without mandating the number of chapters or detailed content in each chapter. However, the structure shall be at the discretion of the advisor.

(2) Publication-based Format refers to the Electronic File format from the publishing or formally accepted for publication in national or international academic journals as a part of the content of the Electronic File.

No. 4 The components and structure of the Electronic File shall be prepared in accordance with the format specified in No. 3 with the following components and structure as prescribed below:

4.1 Traditional Format shall present the content in sequence and be divided into 3 main sections: Front Matter, Body of Contents, and End Matter, with the details as follows:

4.1.1 Front Matter consists of the following details:

4.1.1.1 Cover Page contains the following information:

- Title of the thesis/thematic paper/independent study
- Full name of the author
- Degree awarded
- Year of graduation
- Copyright statement of Mahidol University.

4.1.1.2 Approval Page for the thesis, thematic paper, or independent study committee contains the following information:

- Title of the thesis/thematic paper/independent study
- Full name of the author
- Full names of the advisory committee members and thesis examination committee, with academic titles preceding the names and academic qualifications (preferably highest degree)
- At the bottom of the page indicated Program Chair's full name; name of the faculty/institute/college where the student is enrolled; Head of Academic Unit (Dean/Director); and the Dean of the Faculty of Graduate Studies.

4.1.1.3 Acknowledgements is intended to express gratitude to individuals and organizations that contributed to the completion of the research, including the advisory and examination committees and funding sources. A formal written language (not conversational language) must be applied. When referring to individuals, their full name with title prefix must be stated completely and accurately; if any, include academic titles, ranks, royal titles, or ecclesiastical titles. Length must not exceed 1 page.

4.1.1.4 Abstract shall be prepared in accordance with the requirements of the program. For Thai programs, both Thai and English abstracts shall be provided, while for international programs, only an English abstract is required. Length must not exceed 2 pages. The abstract must include the following information:

- Title of the thesis/thematic paper/independent study
- Full name of the author
- Degree name (abbreviation) and program/field of study
- Full name of advisory committee members
- Abstract
- Keywords (no more than 5) representing the content and aiding retrieval.
- Total number of pages

4.1.1.5 Table of Contents shall list all major components of the Electronic File, along with corresponding page numbers indicated, in the order in which they appear in the Electronic File.

4.1.1.6 List of Tables, List of Figures, and List of Abbreviations (if any) shall indicate the page numbers of all tables, figures, and abbreviations included in the Electronic File.

4.1.2 Body of Contents shall be organized into 6 chapters, with a general scope briefly outlined as follows:

4.1.2.1 Chapter 1 Introduction describes background and significance of the research problem; research objectives; scope of the study; conceptual framework; hypotheses (if any); a brief description of research methodology; underlying assumptions; definitions of terms; and research contribution;

4.1.2.2 Chapter 2 Literature Review compiles comprehensive concepts, theories, and related studies serving as a foundation for the conceptual framework and supporting the direction of the present research;

4.1.2.3 Chapter 3 Research Methodology provides a detailed explanation of the research procedures and methods, including the determination of the population and sample, research instruments, instruments validation, data collection methods, and the statistical techniques or methods used for data analysis;

4.1.2.4 Chapter 4 Results presents the findings of the data analysis or experimental results obtained from the research in a systematic manner, in accordance with the research objectives. The results may be presented in the form of narrative text, tables, charts, or figures, as appropriate;

4.1.2.5 Chapter 5 Discussion summarizes and discusses the research findings in relation to the established concepts, theories, or hypotheses, in order to demonstrate the rationale, consistency, or discrepancies with the related studies presented in Chapter 2;

4.1.2.6 Chapter 6 Conclusion and Recommendations summarizes the key findings of the research, outlines any limitations of the study (if any), and provides recommendations for the application of the research results as well as suggestions for future research.

The preparation of a thesis shall fully comply with the structure and scope of content for each chapter as specified in No. 4.1.2.1 to No. 4.1.2.6. The preparation of a thematic paper and an independent study shall follow the basic structure of the Traditional Format; however, the number of chapters and the level of details in each chapter are not strictly prescribed. The determination of subheadings and details within each chapter may be adjusted as appropriate to the discipline and nature of the research, at the discretion of the major advisor and the examination committee.

4.1.3 End Matter consists of the following details:

4.1.3.1 References/Bibliography refers to lists all books, publications, or audiovisual materials cited in the main body of the work. The reference style is at the discretion of the major advisor and must be applied consistently throughout the Electronic File;

4.1.3.2 Appendix (if any) refers to sections that present data or materials that cannot be incorporated into the main body of the Electronic File but serve as supplementary information to enhance clarity and understanding of the content;

4.1.3.3 Biography shall appear on the final page of the Electronic File and shall include the following information in the specified order:

- Full name of the researcher
- Date and place of birth (province and country)
- Educational background, indicating academic qualifications, institutions attended, and year of graduation, beginning with the bachelor's degree
- Scholarships/research grants received during study
- E-mail
- Publications and academic works
- Awards received during the study or from the publication of the thesis, thematic paper, or independent study.

The Electronic File shall be prepared in accordance with the structure and format prescribed by the Faculty of Graduate studies.

4.2 Publication-based Format shall present the content in sequence and be divided into 3 main sections: Front Matter, Body of Contents, and End Matter, with the details as follows:

4.2.1 Front Matter consists of Cover Page, Approval Page, Acknowledgements, Abstract, and Table of Contents as specified in No. 4.1.1;

4.2.2 Body of Contents shall be divided into chapters corresponding to the number of Electronic File, with the scope of content briefly outlined as follows:

4.2.2.1 Chapter 1 Summary provides an overview synthesis by integrating the content of all presented Electronic File into a coherent and unified narrative. It should also address the background and significance of the study, research objectives, and scope of the study;

4.2.2.2 Chapter 2 Publications presents at least 1 published publications. Each publication clearly titled as a main heading (If more than 1 publication is included, they shall be listed sequentially (e.g., 2.1, 2.2)). The full published versions must be included, with permission from the publisher. Page numbers must be re-numbered consecutively to correspond with the page sequence of the thesis. In this regard, the written proof of publication permission must be attached in the appendix;

4.2.2.3 In cases where the publications do not fully address all research objectives, the student shall include an additional Chapter 3 entitled “**Additional Context**” to present supplementary information, data on the missing aspects, or analysis to ensure that all objectives are comprehensively covered.

4.2.3 End Matter consists of the following components:

4.2.3.1 References/Bibliography shall compile all references cited in the Summary, Publications, and the Additional Context sections, and shall be rearranged into a single consolidated list. A consistent referencing style must be used throughout the entire Electronic File. The citation format shall be determined at the discretion of the major advisor;

4.2.3.2 Appendix (if any) shall be prepared in the same manner as outlined for the Traditional Format under No. 4.1.3.2. In addition, supplementary documents must include evidence of copyright permission from the publisher in cases where the Electronic File have already been published;

4.2.3.3 Biography shall be prepared in the same manner as outlined for the Traditional Format under No. 4.1.3.3.

No. 5 The preparation of the Electronic File shall be undertaken by the student by preparing the required files to ensure readiness for submission into the system, as follows:

5.1 The Electronic File shall contain a complete structure outlined by the Faculty of Graduate Studies under No. 4 and prepare as a single file in PDF (Portable Document Format). The file must follow the following specifications:

5.1.1 The file must be saved in PDF/A (PDF for Archiving) format to ensure the integrity and long-term preservation of the document;

5.1.2 All fonts must be embedded in the file to prevent any distortion or incorrect rendering of text;

5.1.3 All text and illustrations must be clear and legible for on-screen reading and printing.

5.2 The plagiarism check report file shall be prepared following a verify of academic similarity conducted jointly by the student and the advisor, and the report shall be compiled in accordance with the following guidelines:

5.2.1 The student must perform a plagiarism check of the Electronic File using a credible and academically recognized software program (e.g., Turnitin).

5.2.2 The advisor shall review the similarity report, ensuring that the similarity index for the core content does not exceed 25 percent. The report must be approved by the Program Chair in the system before submission to the Faculty of Graduate Studies.

In case the similarity index exceeds 25 percent, the advisor must submit a written justification outlining the reasons to the Faculty of Graduate Studies for further consideration.

No. 6 Submission Process of the Electronic File, once the thesis, thematic paper, or independent study examination result is recorded in the system with the status “Pass,” the student shall proceed as follows:

6.1 Abstract Submission, the student shall log in to the e-Thesis Submission system via the Faculty of Graduate Studies website and complete all required information in the Abstract Submission Form, and submit the information through the system.

6.2 Electronic File Submission, the student shall upload the complete Electronic File (PDF file prepared in accordance with No. 5.1) to the system, in compliance with the following requirements:

6.2.1 In the PDF file, the signature fields on the submission page and the thesis approval page shall be left blank (no signatures required at this stage).

6.2.2 The student shall attach the plagiarism check (Turnitin) report as required under No. 5.2.

6.2.3 The student must await approval from the advisor and the Program Chair through the system. Upon approval is granted, the Faculty of Graduate Studies will subsequently proceed with a review of the formatting accuracy of the Electronic File.

6.3 Submission of the Signed Approval Page, once the Electronic File in the system has been formally approved by the Faculty of Graduate Studies, the student shall proceed as follows:

6.3.1 The student shall ensure that the thesis committee signature page is duly signed by all required parties, including the advisory committee, thesis examination committee, the program chair, and the head of the academic unit (Dean/Director). The signature of the Dean of the Graduate Studies shall be left blank.

6.3.2 The completed signature page shall be submitted to the Faculty of Graduate Studies for the Dean for signature, via the method specified by the Faculty of Graduate Studies (which maybe in printed form or electronic format). The signature may be either a handwritten signature or an electronic signature.

No. 7 The major advisor shall determine the dissemination rights for the Electronic File. The system offers the following dissemination options:

- (1) To publish the full-text Electronic File via the Mahidol University Library and Knowledge Center,
- (2) To publish only the abstract via the Faculty of Graduate Studies website,
- (3) Not to disseminate the Electronic File.

The selection of dissemination rights shall be determined based on the type of Electronic File as follows:

7.1 In the case of the Traditional Format, the selection of the mode of dissemination shall be at the discretion of the major advisor, as deemed appropriate.

7.2 In the case of the Publication-based Format, the decision shall be made based on the evidence of copyright permission granted by the publisher, which shall be taken into consideration as follows:

7.2.1 If complete evidence of copyright permission has been obtained, any of the dissemination options specified in No. 7 may be selected.

7.2.2 If evidence of copyright permission is unavailable or incomplete, dissemination may be selected only under the options specified in No. 7(2) or No. 7(3).

No. 8 The formatting of the Electronic File including layout, font style, margin settings, and other technical specification shall comply with the guidelines and criteria prescribed by the Faculty of Graduate Studies. Student is required to review the official formatting manual, available on the Faculty of Graduate Studies website under the section entitled “Electronic File Requirements”.

No. 9 In cases where principles or procedures are not provided in this announcement, or where issues arise regarding its implementation, the Dean of the Faculty of Graduate Studies shall have the authority to make a determination or issue directives. Such determinations or directives of the Dean of the Faculty of Graduate Studies shall be final.

No. 10 This announcement shall be effective from March 2, 2026 onwards.

Announced on March 2, 2026



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